

2000 - 97

CFO-ORC FILL

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS - SIGHT RECORD FORM

NEW STATE RECORD _____ UNUSUAL RECORD X

7-0 (A)

Rec'd 1/29/01 wpl

Species: Bell's Vireo (*Vireo bellii*)**Date:** 13 June 2000**Number seen:** one**Sex:** male**Plumage:** not seen**Locality:** ½ mile west of Kenney Reservoir on an island in the White River**Elevation:** 5400 ft**Nearest town:** Rangely**County:** Rio Blanco**Time observed:** 0735-0750**Duration of observation:** I heard the bird singing for about 15 minutes**Description:**

I saw the bird in flight for a couple of seconds. The blurry image showed yellow underparts and darkish upperparts. It's kind of hard to rule many other species out with this description (Scrub Greenlet for instance), but I heard the song repeatedly. I never saw the bird perched.

Describe the bird's song and call, if given, including method of delivery (i.e. from perch, in flight, duration): Song had a scolding quality to it, as if it were saying "what the hell do you want with me?" It sang repeatedly, on the order of about 20 times before we left and were out of hearing range. The notes, which were so tightly packed into the song that distinct individual notes were hard to distinguish, had a squeaky "feel" to them like on old tape being rewound. This is one of the hardest songs to describe since there really aren't plaintive notes, whistles, or a good mnemonic phrase to go with it, but rather a garble of notes thrown together in a very rapid song that lasted about 2 seconds. Hopefully Rich Levad's report will provide a reliable visual description to go along with my poor attempt to describe its song.

What is your prior experience with this and similarly-appearing species? I have seen and heard dozens of this species singing, especially while conducting surveys specifically for Bell's Vireo in eastern Colorado in 1999 for the Colorado Bird Observatory. For what it's worth, I am 100% confident of this identification based solely on its song.

Light conditions: slightly overcast, sun low, behind and left

Optical equipment used: Zeiss 7x42

Distance, and how estimated: estimated closest distance at 5 meters

Other observers who saw the bird with you: Rich Levad

Other observers who saw the bird independently: none that I know of

If photographed, type of equipment and film: I did not photograph

List books, illustrations, recordings, other birders, etc. consulted and how this influenced your identification:

a) at time of observation: none

b) after observation: National Geographic Birds of North America 3rd ed. Looked to see if there were any populations close to western Colorado.

Reporting observer: Doug Faulkner

Signature: 

Address: Rocky Mountain Bird Observatory, 14500 Lark Bunting Lane, Brighton, CO 80601

Date report was written: This report was written on 20 June 2000 from memory.